Colson Montgomery

Bats left · 2026 · 633 PA · xChase+ 68, 257th of 261

Swings at 33% of pitches outside the zone. Hitters on average swing at 29% of the same pitches.

COST OF FAR-OFF CHASES

3.1

runs per 600 PA from your choices on pitches 4+ inches off the plate

What to work on

1. When you're ahead, mostly against right-handers, let breaking balls below the zone go. You swung at 57% of them; hitters on average swing at 25%. The ones you swung at were typically 9 inches off the zone. You miss on 68% of your chases, against 45% for other hitters on the same pitches: contact is your bigger cost, so this one is a take even when you could reach it.

leak (2)

2. With two strikes, mostly against right-handers, let breaking balls below the zone go. You swung at these about as often as other hitters do, but more of yours came at 0-2 and 3-2, and over a season they cost you 1.9 runs. The ones you swung at were typically 4 inches off the zone. In this count your choices are a plus overall (+1.5 runs in the count table); this pitch is where they give some back.

leak (1)

- Your choices also cost about 2 runs a season on the first pitch and 1 at 0-1 or 1-1, spread over many pitches rather than one take.

Keep swinging at strikes; your fastball decisions are a strength. The changes to start with are the pitches above.

TARGET

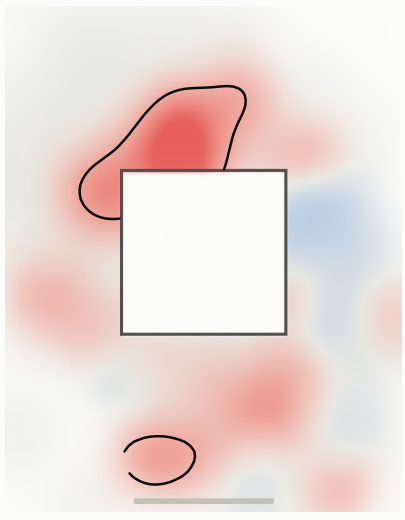
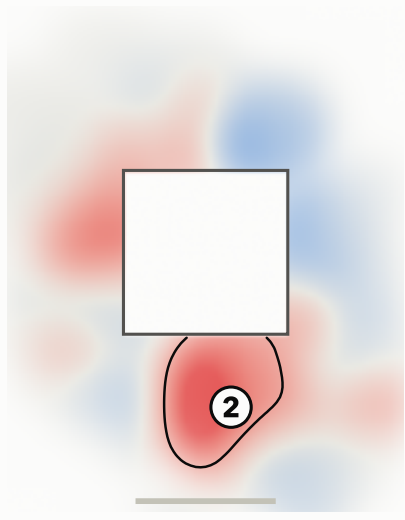
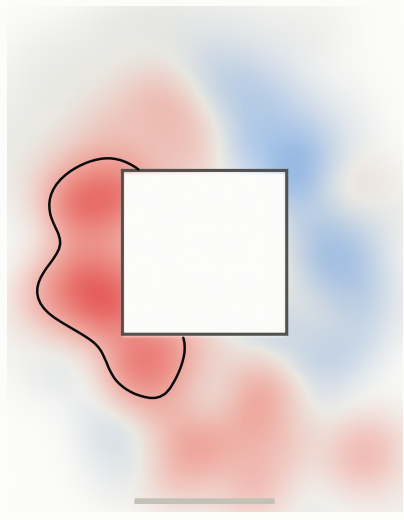
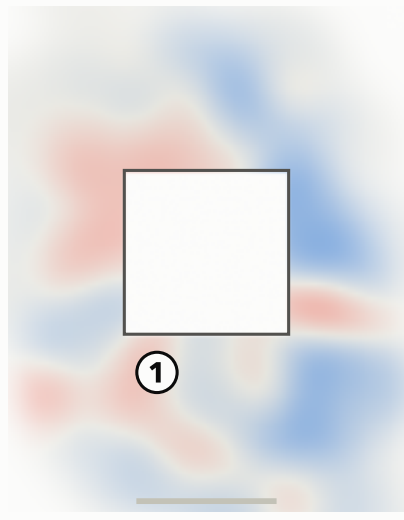
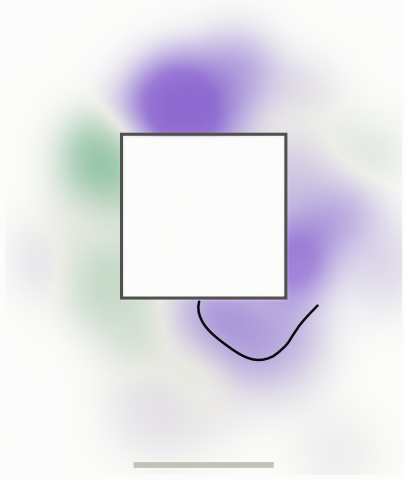
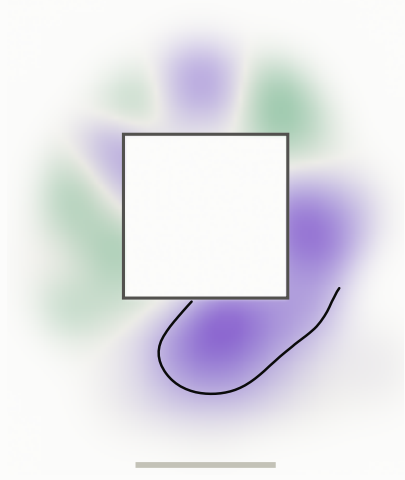
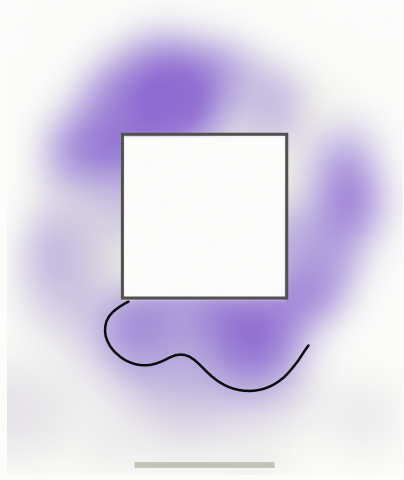
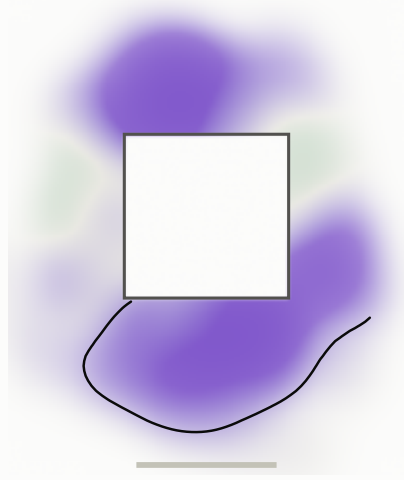
No chase target: leaks 1 and 2 together were 10 points above the league's chase rate in 2026 (4 on the simpler league rate the target uses), and with no change should be about at it in 2027. The number to move is contact on chases.

COACH'S NOTE, FOR THE STAFF

When he is ahead, mostly against right-handers, breaking balls below the zone: the plan's first take. A contact problem: two chases in three are misses, so a chase is close to a sure strike. With two strikes, the same pitch, mostly from right-handers, is the plan's second line.

Where you chase

−30 pts league +30 pts

	First pitch (0-0)	Ahead in the count (1-0 2-0 3-0 2-1 3-1)	0-1 or 1-1 (even or behind)	Two strikes (0-2 1-2 2-2 3-2)
vs RHP right-handed pitchers				
Misses on chases swing-and-miss per chase, vs the average hitter: purple more, green fewer				

Away Inside catcher's view, to scale

Red: you chase more than the average hitter at that spot and count. Blue: you take more. Gray: about average. White: too few pitches to say. Outline: 15 points or more over. Misses row: purple, more misses than the average hitter on the same chases; green, fewer.

Biggest leaks

		numbered on the pictures · runs per 600 PA
(1)	Two strikes, mostly vs RHP, breaking balls below the zone	58% vs 54% · 43 of 74 **−1.9**
(2)	Ahead in the count, mostly vs RHP, breaking balls below the zone	57% vs 25% · 12 of 21 **−1.3**

You vs the average hitter on the same pitches; the runs are what the swing choices cost. Ranked by runs; the plan takes up to two, in the order to work on them.

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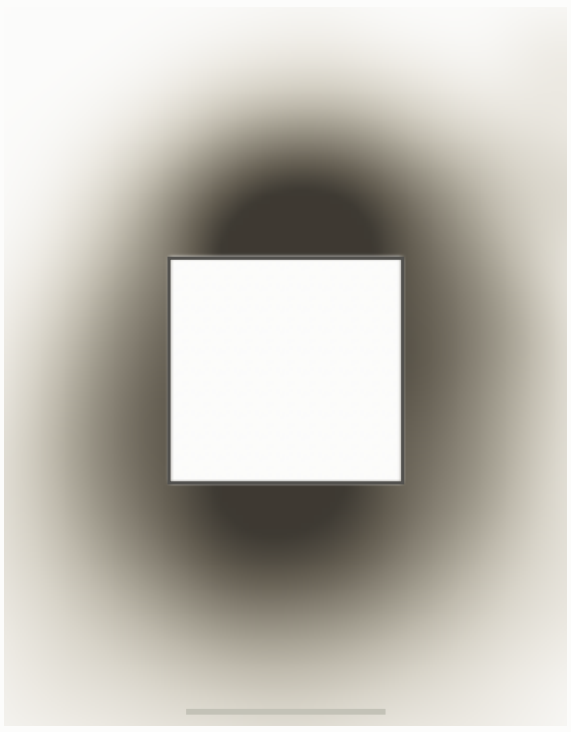
runs per 600 PA from your choices on pitches 4+ inches off the plate

How to read your card

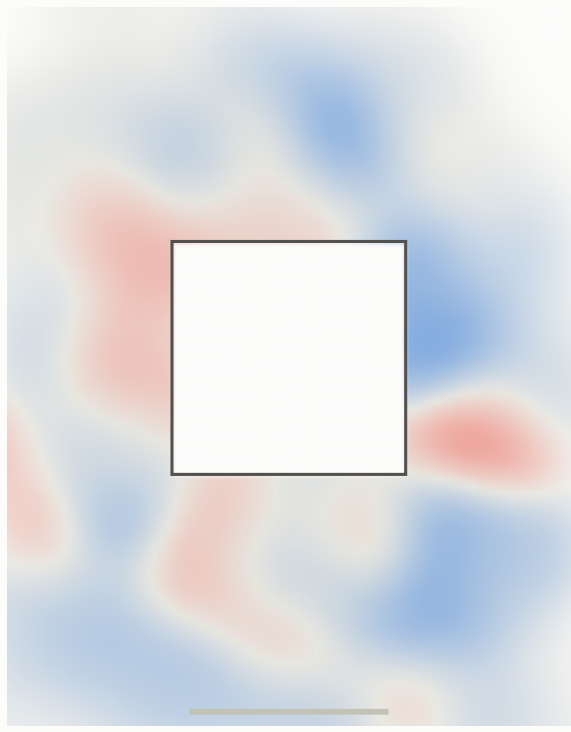
1. Red is where you swing at balls more than other hitters do at the same spot and in the same count. Blue is where you take more than they do. Gray is about average. White means you haven't seen enough pitches there to say.
2. The box is your strike zone, seen from the catcher. The line under it is home plate. Everyone chases more with two strikes, so the comparison is always with hitters in the same count. Nobody is judged for a two-strike swing everyone makes.
3. The numbers on the pictures are your biggest leaks, ranked by what your swing choices cost over a full season, each on the row of pictures its pitches are in (a leak against right-handers is on the vs RHP row). Each plan line is tagged with its leak's number.
4. The plan is one pitch per line, numbered 1 and 2 in the order to work on them: a take before two strikes comes first, because it costs nothing in strikeouts, when you have seen enough of those pitches to trust the number, unless your coaches picked where to start. A line under them names a bigger leak or a costly count that comes later. A take rule is for the pitch that is clearly a ball; each line says how far off the plate the ones you swung at were, and a pitch that was mostly borderline is one to go over on video with your coaches, not a take. Keep swinging at strikes.
5. The target covers every leak on the card, together, in points above the league's chase rate. Everyone's worst spots look better the next season by themselves, and that is the numbers settling, not you improving. The second number is where you would land doing nothing. Under it is a fix. Matching it is not.
6. The cost of far-off chases is what your choices on pitches at least 4 inches off the plate cost over 600 plate appearances, compared with an average hitter. Hitters who cut their leak chasing mostly stopped losing runs; the walks come first, the hits come later if they come.

What normal looks like, with two strikes

The average hitter: how often they swing



You: more (red) or less (blue) than that



Average hitter's chase rate

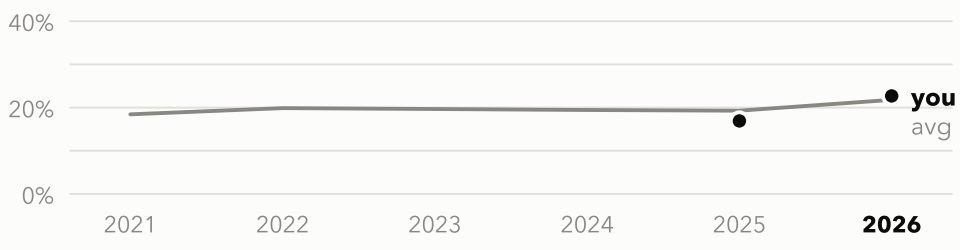
0% 70%+

You vs the average hitter

−30 pts league +30 pts

The average hitter chases most with two strikes, below and away. Your card only shows where you differ from that.

Far-off chase rate by season (2 seasons)



Pitches at least 4 inches off the plate: you against every hitter.

Does fixing a leak pay? Hitters who cut their leak chasing more than expected stopped giving counts away: more walks, no more strikeouts, still swinging at strikes. The gain was mostly runs not lost; hits come later, if they come.